

Dear Author,

This proposal addresses a highly relevant and growing challenge in science communication, that is the spread of health misinformation through social media platforms. The applicant clearly identified a target audience of teenagers and young adults and provided a strong rationale for focusing on TikTok as the communication platform of focus. The proposed initiative appears well-positioned to support the stated objective of improving health literacy by connecting with audiences where they are already consuming health information - TikTok.

A major strength this proposal is its practicality, accessibility, and the minimal equipment required. The use of TikTok's duet feature leverages the tools already being used on the platform to engage audiences directly with misinformation, providing a direct sense of accountability to content creators as well. The eight-week pilot project is scoped appropriately for testing logistics, but not so much for testing engagement and project impact. The proposal demonstrates a strong potential impact. By engaging with health-related content already circulating online, the initiative has the opportunity to increase awareness of misinformation and encourage thoughtful and critical consumption of health information.

While the proposal is strong overall, several areas would benefit from further clarification. Most notably, the project's primary objective is somewhat unclear. The proposal states that its goal is to help participants develop the skills needed to critically evaluate health claims online, rather than correcting information online. However, the activities described appear to focus primarily on evaluating and fact-checking individual claims. As written, the initiative functions more as a misinformation-correction platform than an educational program designed to teach information evaluation skills. Clarifying whether the primary objective is to correct misinformation, teach skills, or accomplish both, would strengthen the proposal and improve alignment between the objectives and the actual proposed implementation.

Additionally, while the eight-week pilot seems realistic for content creation and implementation, it may not provide sufficient time to meaningfully evaluate audience growth, engagement, and long-term impact. Success on TikTok is heavily influenced by platform algorithms, audience development, and the credibility of the account, all of which take time to establish. As a newly created account, engagement metrics may not capture project success, and MedTok Mythbusters may experience limited visibility during the pilot phase regardless of content quality. The applicant may wish to clarify how project success will be evaluated in a manner that accounts for these challenges.

Finally, additional detail regarding how health claims will be classified as supported, unsupported, or requiring additional context would strengthen confidence in the initiative's scientific rigor and consistency. A clearer description of the role of health professionals in reviewing content would further enhance the credibility of the proposed initiative. Overall, this is a creative, timely, and feasible science communication proposal that addresses an important public health issue. The initiative demonstrates strong potential to engage young audiences and improve health literacy. With minor revisions to clarify the project's objectives and strengthen its evaluation framework, I would recommend this proposal for funding.

- Anonymous Reviewer